CLASS 9 · SOCIAL SCIENCE · RAPID REVISION

SST Exam Pack

History Ch 5 · State and Society up to 1000 CE | Civics Ch 6 · Democracy | Civics Ch 7 · Elections

Each chapter in three parts — quick notes to understand it fully, 10 must-know definitions, and 10 MCQs with an answer key.

3 CHAPTERS | 30 DEFINITIONS | 30 MCQs | ANSWER KEYS WITH REASONS | PRINT-FRIENDLY

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01 HISTORY · CHAPTER 5
State and Society up to 1000 CE

PART A Chapter Notes

The big picture. This chapter tracks how state and society grew in the Indian subcontinent up to 1000 CE. A **society** is a system of social relationships among people who share a territory, culture and a sense of belonging — it runs mainly on customs, not formal laws. A **state** is an organised political system based on rules and laws, with defined rights and duties for rulers and subjects. The broad evolution runs: kin-based clans (**janas**) → territorial states (**janapadas**) → 16 **mahājanapadas** → great empires (Mauryas, Guptas, Cholas) — while shared ideas like **dharma** and the ideal of the **chakravarti samrāj** treated the subcontinent as one political entity.

The Vedic period. The Vedas are the earliest known corpus of Indian literature — composed orally in the north-west (**Sapta-Sindhu**), with the **Ṛig Veda** (about 1,028 hymns) being the world's oldest surviving poetic compositions. There are four Vedas: **Ṛig Veda** (hymns of praise), **Yajur Veda** (ritual instructions), **Sāma Veda** (hymns arranged for singing — foundation of the seven **svaras** of Indian music) and **Atharva Veda** (hymns for protection and healing); each has four parts — samhitā, brāhmaṇa, āraṇyaka, upaniṣhad. Society was organised as janas (clans); the **rājā** was mainly a clan chief who led in war, and three assemblies limited his power — the **sabhā** (small, elite, judicial), the **samiti** (larger, policy) and the **vidhata** (popular gathering of the jana). The name **"Bharata"** itself first appears in the Ṛig Veda, from the Bharata jana.

From janas to states. From about 1000 BCE, iron tools and the fertile Ganga plains created **agricultural surplus** — control of land, produce and trade routes became valuable, so more complex administration was needed. Identity shifted from kinship to territory: a janapada is literally **"where a jana first set its feet."** By the 6th century BCE there were **16 mahājanapadas** in two forms — monarchies (rājyas) and republics (**gaṇa-saṁghas**, like Vajji). **Magadha** (today's Bihar) became the most powerful — strategic location, fertile plains, strong rulers — and later formed the base of the Mauryan Empire. Far south, the Sangam age (300 BCE–300 CE) saw the three crowned kingdoms of Tamilakam: **Cholas (tiger), Cheras (bow), Pandyas (fish)** — remember, these early kingdoms are centuries older than the imperial Cholas of the 9th–11th centuries CE.

Ideals of kingship. From the 6th century BCE rulers used titles like rājā, mahārāja and samrāj. The Yajur Veda's coronation oath made a king promise to judge the strong and the weak **impartially**, protect the country and do good to the people; Kauṭilya's **Arthaśhāstra** insisted that "only if a king is himself energetically active, do his officers follow him energetically." Kingship was usually hereditary, yet references to kings being elected or expelled show royal authority was **not always absolute**. Monarchs also saw the whole subcontinent as one field of power: **Jambudvīpa**, **Bhāratavarṣha**, the aśhvamedha and rājasūya yajñas, and the **chakravarti-kśhetra** ("the area between Himavat and the sea") — an ideal later echoed by Rajendra I's title **Gangaikonda**.

How empires were administered. Kauṭilya's **Saptāṁga** lists the seven limbs of a state — king, ministers, territory, forts, treasury, army and allies ("one wheel does not move the carriage"). The king consulted a council of ministers (**mantri-pariṣhad**), while kingdoms were layered: provinces → divisions → districts → groups of villages → **villages** (the smallest unit). Highlights: the **Guptas** (320–550 CE) created a new minister of peace and war (**sāndhivigrahika**), and their Damodarpur plates show a district office of five members; the **Pallavas** granted tax-free **brahmadeya** villages with active assemblies; the **Chālukyas** gave **agrahārams** to Brahmin settlements that became centres of learning; the **Gurjara-Pratihāras** fought the tri-partite struggle for Kannauj against the Pālas and Rāṣhṭrakūṭas; and the **imperial Cholas** ran maṇḍalam → valanāḍu → nāḍu → Ur, with **self-reliant village assemblies** that collected revenue, managed irrigation and settled disputes.

Village democracy — two case studies. The **Uttaramerur inscription** of the Chola king Parantaka I (10th century CE) records the **Kudavolai** ("ballot pot") system: candidates' names written on palm leaves went into a pot, and a young child drew the leaves **in full public view** to select members of the village assembly and its committees (variyams for tanks, justice and taxes) — candidates needed "honest earnings" and a pure mind. And one rock at **Junagadh** (Girnar, Gujarat) carries inscriptions of **three rulers across ~700 years**: Aśhoka's Dhamma edicts, Rudradaman I's Sanskrit record repairing the **Sudarshana Lake**, and Skandagupta's restoration of the same lake.

Dharma and ethics. **Dharma is not "religion"** — it is duty, righteousness and moral conduct ("that which upholds beings"; root *dhṛi*), with **dhamma** as its Pali form used by Aśhoka. The Ṛig Veda's **ṛita** is the cosmic order keeping nature and society in balance; **samatva** teaches that all beings share one essence. The Bhagavad Gītā stresses knowledge, faith, action and virtue. Ethics ran through governance too — Uttaramerur office-bearers had to show honest earnings.

Social structure — varṇa, jāti, family. The four **varṇas** — brāhmaṇas, kṣhatriyas, vaiśhyas, śhūdras — are first mentioned in the **Puruṣhasūkta** (Book 10, Ṛig Veda). Early on the order was occupational and flexible: Ṛig Veda 9.112.3 says "I am a poet, my father is a physician, my mother grinds corn," and a Buddhist text holds that no one is a brāhmaṇa "by birth, only by deeds." **Jātis** emerged later through intermarriage, endogamous migrant communities and regional differences — varṇas stayed four, jātis kept multiplying. Society was not fully rigid: the **Mandsaur inscription** records silk weavers who also took up archery and astrology. Family life ran kula → grāma → viśha → jana;

gotra (patrilineal descent from a sage) regulated marriage; life moved through four **āśhramas** (brahmacharya, gṛihastha, vānaprastha, saṁnyāsa) and aimed at four **puruṣhārthas** (dharma, artha, kāma, mokṣha).

Women. In the Vedic period women took part in learning, rituals, chariot races and the sabhā — hymns are attributed to women sages like **Apālā, Ghoṣhā and Lopāmudrā**. The Manu-Smṛiti says "where women are honoured, there the gods rejoice." Their position later declined with changing conditions, but women kept contributing: **Prabhāvatī Gupta** ruled as regent and issued land grants in her own name; Sangam poetesses like **Avvaiyar** became famous; the Chola queen **Sembiyan Mahādevī** endowed temples.

Religion and Bhakti. Vedic deities were linked to nature (sun, rain, fire, dawn) and worshipped through **yajñas** — a vision of nature as sacred that survives in Chhath and Makar Sankranti. From the mid-1st millennium BCE, **renunciants** (śhramaṇas, bhikṣhus, parivrājakas — including **Gautama Buddha and Mahāvīra**) questioned elaborate ritual. The tradition then evolved towards devotion to Viṣhṇu, Śhiva and Śhakti: **Bhakti** — a direct, personal bond with god without costly rituals, **open to every class and gender**. In the Tamil country the **12 Āḻvārs** (Viṣhṇu) and **63 Nāyanmārs** (Śhiva) created the great body of Tamil Bhakti literature from the 6th century.

Education and literature. Education was holistic, taught in the **gurukula** through a sacred guru–śhiṣhya bond — the Vedas plus grammar, logic, mathematics, medicine, astronomy, arts and archery. Great centres included **Takshashila, Nalanda (427 CE), Valabhi (c. 480 CE)** and Vikramashila, drawing students from abroad. Classics include Pāṇini's grammar, **Kālidāsa's** Raghuvaṁśha, **Tiruvalluvar's** Tirukkural and **Bāṇabhaṭṭa's** Kādambarī — celebrated as one of the world's first novels.

Economy. The Mauryan state took a basic land tax of about **one-sixth (1/6)** of the produce and actively built irrigation — the **Sudarshana Lake** dam (built under Chandragupta Maurya, repaired by Rudradaman I, restored by Skandagupta) and Karikala Chola's **Grand Anicut, still in use today**. From the 6th century BCE two great routes — **Uttarāpatha** (north) and **Dakṣiṇāpatha** (south) — linked inland regions to ports like **Muziris and Poompuhar**. **Guilds (śhreṇīs)** — 18 types in the Jātaka — fixed quality and prices, ran guild courts and worked as **banks**: the Nashik cave inscription records 3,000 kāhāpaṇas deposited with weavers' guilds, whose interest maintained Buddhist monasteries.

PART B 10 Must-Know Definitions

TERM	EXAM-READY DEFINITION
Jana	A clan or group bound by kinship ties — the basic unit of early Vedic society. The Ṛig Veda mentions about 30 janas; the five chief ones were called the **pañchajana**.
Janapada	Literally "where a jana first set its feet" (c. 1000–600 BCE) — the shift from kinship identity to **territorial identity**, i.e. belonging to a land.
Mahājanapada	A bigger political unit than a janapada; **16** existed by the 6th century BCE, in two forms — monarchies (rājyas) and republics (gaṇa-saṁghas).
Gaṇa-Saṁgha	A **non-monarchical (republican) state** ruled collectively rather than by a hereditary king — **Vajji** is the classic example.
Dharma	Not "religion" — **duty, obligation, righteousness and moral conduct**; "that which upholds beings." Its Pali form, **dhamma**, was used by Aśhoka and in Buddhism.
Ṛita	The **all-pervading cosmic order** that maintains harmony and balance in nature and society, described in the Ṛig Veda.
Chakravarti samrāj / kśhetra	The ideal of a **universal paramount ruler** over the whole subcontinent; the chakravarti-kśhetra = "the area between Himavat (the Himalayas) and the sea" (Arthaśhāstra).
Varṇa vs Jāti	**Varṇa:** the four social categories (earliest mention: Puruṣhasūkta, Book 10, Ṛig Veda). **Jāti:** birth-based groups that kept multiplying — varṇas stayed four, jātis had no limit.
Gotra	A **patrilineal lineage** (clan) traced back to a common Vedic sage (ṛiṣhi); it regulated marriage alliances.
Śhreṇī	A **guild** — an association of artisans, traders or merchants of one profession; it regulated quality and prices, ran guild courts, and acted as a **bank** (Nashik cave inscription, 2nd century CE).

PART C 10 MCQs — Test Yourself

1. Which Veda, with hymns arranged for musical recitation, is regarded as the foundation of the seven svaras (notes) of Indian music?

(a) Ṛig Veda **(b)** Yajur Veda
(c) Sāma Veda **(d)** Atharva Veda

2. Which assembly–function pair is correctly matched?

(a) Sabhā — larger policy assembly **(b)** Samiti — elite judicial body
(c) Vidhata — popular gathering of the jana **(d)** Sabhā — popular gathering of the jana

3. The rise of janapadas (c. 1000–600 BCE) marked a shift from:

(a) kinship-based identity to territory-based identity **(b)** territory-based identity to kinship
(c) monarchy to republic **(d)** villages to cities

4. Which one of the following mahājanapadas was a republic (gaṇa-saṁgha) rather than a monarchy?

(a) Magadha **(b)** Vajji
(c) Kosala **(d)** Avanti

5. Magadha emerged as the most powerful mahājanapada mainly because of its:

(a) coastal ports **(b)** strategic location, fertile plains and strong rulers
(c) gold mines **(d)** foreign alliances

6. In the Arthaśhāstra, Prithivi — the chakravarti-kśhetra — is defined as:

(a) the land between the Ganga and the Yamuna
(b) the area between Himavat (the Himalayas) and the sea
(c) the Deccan plateau
(d) the Sapta-Sindhu region

7. "Dharma" in early Indian thought is best described as:

(a) an organised religion
(b) duty, righteousness and moral conduct
(c) a Vedic ritual
(d) a law book

8. The earliest reference to the four varṇas is found in:

(a) the Puruṣhasūkta hymn, Book 10 of the Ṛig Veda
(b) the Sutta Nipāta
(c) the Arthaśhāstra
(d) the Tolkappiyam

9. The Nashik cave inscription (2nd century CE) shows that guilds (śhreṇīs) functioned as:

(a) village assemblies
(b) banking institutions paying interest on deposits
(c) royal courts
(d) universities

10. In the Kudavolai system described in the Uttaramerur inscriptions, village representatives were chosen by:

(a) a show of hands
(b) appointment by the king
(c) drawing palm-leaf names from a pot by a young child in public view
(d) election by priests

ANSWER KEY · HISTORY CH 5

1. (c) Sāma Veda — hymns set for singing; source of the 7 svaras.
2. (c) Vidhata = popular gathering; sabhā = elite judicial, samiti = policy.
3. (a) Janapada = "where the jana set its feet" — identity tied to land, not kinship.
4. (b) Vajji was a gaṇa-saṁgha; Magadha, Kosala, Avanti were monarchies.
5. (b) Strategic location + fertile plains + strong rulers made Magadha supreme.
6. (b) Arthaśhāstra: Prithivi lies "between Himavat and the sea."
7. (b) Dharma = duty / righteousness / moral conduct — not an organised religion.
8. (a) Puruṣhasūkta (Book 10, Ṛig Veda) — earliest mention of the 4 varṇas.
9. (b) 3,000 kāhāpaṇas deposited with weavers' guilds at fixed interest — guilds as banks.
10. (c) Kudavolai: palm-leaf names drawn from a pot by a child, in full public view.

02 CIVICS · CHAPTER 6 Democracy

PART A Chapter Notes

What democracy means. **Democracy** is a form of government in which the source of power and authority lies with the **citizens**, who elect representatives through free and fair elections; it is founded on freedom, equality, justice, rights and duties. India is the **world's largest democracy** — over 140 crore people and about **96.8 crore voters (2024)**. Its Constitution was **adopted on 26 November 1949** and **came into force on 26 January 1950**, guaranteeing Fundamental Rights to every citizen without discrimination on religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth.

India's long democratic story. Democratic ideas are not new to India: Vedic assemblies — the **sabhā, samiti and vidhata** — practised collective decision-making, some early states were republics (**gaṇa-saṁghas**), and the **Buddha's Saṁgha** chose its leader and voted on decisions; a Ṛig Veda verse even praises assemblies whose "counsel is one." British colonisation restricted people's participation, but the freedom struggle revived democratic ideas. After independence, the **Constituent Assembly** (formed 1946) took **2 years, 11 months and 18 days** to draft the world's **longest written Constitution**, with **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** chairing the Drafting Committee. **Article 368** allows lawful amendments, keeping the Constitution a living, flexible document.

Seven non-negotiable principles. (1) **Popular sovereignty** — ultimate power lies with the people, exercised through **Universal Adult Franchise**: every citizen 18+ votes by secret ballot. (2) **Rule of law** — no one is above the law; disputes are settled by courts, not force. (3) **Fundamental Rights** — six enforceable rights safeguarding freedom and dignity. (4) **Separation of powers** — legislature, executive and judiciary check one another. (5) **Accountability and transparency** — through elections, Question Hour and the **RTI Act (2005)**. (6) **Multi-party system** — a party or coalition with more than 50% of seats forms the government; the rest form the opposition. (7) **Safeguarding vulnerable groups** — **Article 46** directs special care for weaker sections, especially SCs and STs.

Fundamental Rights. The six Fundamental Rights with their Articles: **Equality (14–18), Freedom (19–22), against Exploitation (23–24), Freedom of Religion (25–28), Cultural & Educational (29–30)**, and **Constitutional Remedies (32)** — under which courts can be moved whenever a right is violated (also Article 226). They are enforceable, indivisible and inalienable. **Article 21A** (added 2009) makes education free and compulsory for children aged **6–14**. Exam trap: don't confuse Fundamental Rights (enforceable) with **Fundamental Duties** (our responsibilities) or **Directive Principles** (guidelines for the state).

Institutions, accountability, media. Power is shared across a **three-tier system** — Union, State and local governments. Independent bodies keep the government answerable: the **CAG** audits accounts, the **CIC** implements RTI, the **Lokpal** and **CVC** investigate wrongdoing; **Question Hour** lets members question the government daily. The media is called the **fourth pillar of democracy** — informing people and raising public issues. The **RTI Act (2005)** became law through a fully democratic journey: citizens' concerns → parliamentary committees → expert review → debate → safeguards → law — proof that ordinary people can shape legislation.

Types of democracy. In a **direct democracy** citizens decide most matters themselves — realistic only in small countries like **Switzerland**. Large countries use **representative democracy**, as in India. Within that, a **parliamentary system** (India, UK, Canada) draws its executive from the legislature and keeps it accountable to it — you vote for your MP, not the PM. A **presidential system** (USA) elects the executive

directly and separately from the legislature. There is no single model — but freedom, equality, participation, rule of law, rights and duties are common everywhere.

India's living democracy. One MP represents about **25 lakh people**; elections run in **22 scheduled languages**, with symbols helping non-literate voters vote independently; there are **over a million polling stations** — sometimes for a single voter — and **2,800+ registered parties**. Tribal regions get special self-governance: **Autonomous District Councils** in the north-east and the **PESA Act (1996)**, which empowers the Gram Sabha in Scheduled Areas. Grassroots proof: **Jethipura** (Gujarat) won the national NDRGGSP award (2019) for its effective Gram Sabhas, and **South Manubankul** (Tripura) is a nationally recognised women-friendly panchayat.

Women and democracy. Indian women got full voting rights **from the very start (1950)** — while American women waited until **1920** and British women until **1928**. But the right to vote is not the same as equal participation; social prejudice still limits women's representation in politics. The Constitution pushes participation forward: not less than **one-third** of Panchayat seats are reserved for women (**Article 243D**) and one-third in Municipalities (**Article 243T**); **21 states and 2 UTs** have raised the Panchayat share to **50%**.

The Emergency (1975–77). Rising dissatisfaction, unemployment, inflation and protests against the government of **Indira Gandhi** led to a **National Emergency** in June 1975, declared on grounds of internal disturbance (Emergency provisions sit in **Articles 352, 356 and 360**). Most **Fundamental Rights were suspended**, the **press was censored**, and opposition leaders were arrested. **Jayaprakash Narayan** — "Lok Nayak" — mobilised students and citizens, especially in Bihar and Gujarat. The Emergency was lifted in 1977; elections followed and **the ruling government was defeated** — showing both democracy's vulnerability and its resilience.

Challenges and young citizens. Indian democracy still faces illiteracy, poverty, inequality, regionalism, gender discrimination and **misinformation on social media**, which can manipulate public opinion. Everyone must act responsibly — not spreading rumours, not damaging public property, staying informed through newspapers and reliable news. Programmes like **NSS, NCC and Bharat Scouts & Guides** build civic responsibility among students. Democracy, finally, is not merely a system of government but a continuous process shaped by active, informed citizens.

PART B 10 Must-Know Definitions

TERM	EXAM-READY DEFINITION
Democracy	A form of government in which the source of power and authority lies with the **citizens**, who elect representatives through free and fair elections; founded on freedom, equality, justice, rights and duties.
Popular sovereignty	The principle that the **ultimate source of power is the people**; the state derives its authority from them.
Universal Adult Franchise	Every citizen aged **18 and above** has the right to vote through a **secret ballot**, without discrimination.
Rule of law	**No one is above the law**; everyone is equal before it, and disputes are settled by established legal procedures — not force or influence.
Fundamental Rights	The **six rights** guaranteed by the Constitution (Articles 14–32): equality, freedom, against exploitation, freedom of religion, cultural & educational, and constitutional remedies — enforceable in courts.
Separation of powers	Division of power among the **legislature** (makes laws), the **executive** (implements them) and the **judiciary** (interprets them) — with checks and balances.
Judicial review	The judiciary's power to declare a law or amendment **unconstitutional** if it is inconsistent with the Constitution.
Federalism	Sharing of power and responsibilities between the **central and state governments** (Union, State and Concurrent Lists).
Direct vs Representative democracy	**Direct:** citizens themselves take most decisions (Switzerland). **Representative:** citizens elect representatives to govern on their behalf (India).
Emergency	Extraordinary constitutional provision (Articles **352, 356, 360**); the National Emergency of 1975–77 suspended most Fundamental Rights and censored the press.

PART C 10 MCQs — Test Yourself

1. The Constituent Assembly was formed in 1946 and took _____ to draft the Constitution:

(a) 1 year 6 months **(b)** 2 years 11 months 18 days
(c) 3 years 5 months **(d)** 5 years

2. Who chaired the Drafting Committee of the Constitution?

(a) Jawaharlal Nehru **(b)** Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(c) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar **(d)** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

3. Universal Adult Franchise means:

(a) only educated citizens can vote **(b)** every citizen aged 18+ votes through a secret ballot, without discrimination
(c) one vote per family **(d)** only taxpayers can vote

4. Under which Article can citizens move the courts directly when their Fundamental Rights are violated?

(a) Article 14 **(b)** Article 19
(c) Article 21A **(d)** Article 32

5. Free and compulsory education for children aged 6–14 became a Fundamental Right through:

(a) Article 21A **(b)** Article 17
(c) Article 44 **(d)** Article 368

6. The Right to Information (RTI) Act, empowering citizens to seek information from government departments, came into force in:

(a) 1950 **(b)** 1975
(c) 1996 **(d)** 2005

7. Which country is the best-known example of direct democracy?

(a) India **(b)** the United Kingdom
(c) Switzerland **(d)** the United States

8. In a parliamentary democracy like India's:

(a) the executive is elected directly by the people, separate from the legislature **(b)** the executive is drawn from and accountable to the legislature
(c) the judiciary elects the Prime Minister **(d)** there are no political parties

9. Indian women received the right to vote:

(a) only in 1920, as in the USA **(b)** only in 1928, as in Britain
(c) from the very start — with Universal Adult Franchise in 1950 **(d)** only after 1975

10. Which statement about the Emergency of 1975–77 is correct?

(a) Elections were held every year **(b)** Most Fundamental Rights were suspended, the press was censored, Jayaprakash Narayan led the resistance, and the government was defeated in 1977
(c) The Constitution was abolished **(d)** The RTI Act was passed

ANSWER KEY · CIVICS CH 6

1. (b) 2 years 11 months 18 days — the world's longest written Constitution.
2. (c) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee.
3. (b) UAF = every citizen 18+, secret ballot, no discrimination.
4. (d) Article 32 — Right to Constitutional Remedies; courts can be moved directly.
5. (a) Article 21A (added 2009) — free, compulsory education for ages 6–14.
6. (d) RTI Act came into force in 2005.
7. (c) Switzerland — citizens participate directly; India is representative.
8. (b) Parliamentary: the executive sits in and answers to the legislature.
9. (c) From 1950 — Britain 1928, USA 1920.
10. (b) FRs suspended, press censored, JP Narayan's resistance, 1977 defeat.

03 CIVICS · CHAPTER 7 Elections

PART A Chapter Notes

Why elections matter. An **election** is the process through which we exercise our right to vote and fulfil our responsibility as citizens; **regular, periodic elections lie at the core of democracy**. They deliver four things — **accountability** (the government must answer to the people), **representation** (our voice reaches government through a representative), **legitimacy** (a mandate from the people makes government lawful) and **equality** (every vote counts the same — a PM's and a labourer's alike). Our vote is the principal means of exercising this right.

Three ways to turn votes into seats. In **First-Past-The-Post (FPTP)**, used for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections, the candidate with the **most votes wins even with less than 50%** — in the textbook's **Haritbhumi**, Party A won 40%, B 35%, C 25%, and A formed the government. In the **majority system**, a winner needs **over 50%**; if nobody crosses it, the top two fight a second round — in **Ratnadeep**, Y won the second round with 55%. In **Proportional Representation (PR)**, used for **Rajya Sabha, Presidential and Vice-Presidential** elections, seats go in proportion to votes — in **Swarnalok** (100 seats), a party with 40% of the votes gets 40 seats and power is shared.

The single transferable vote (STV). PR in India works through STV. Voters mark preferences (1st, 2nd, 3rd…); the **quota** — the minimum votes needed to win — equals **total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled**. Candidates reaching the quota on first preferences are elected; the lowest-polling candidate is **eliminated** and their votes **transfer** to the second preferences marked on those ballot papers; this repeats until enough candidates are elected. Six states are **bicameral** (they also have a Vidhan Parishad chosen this way): **Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh** — its members are elected by MLAs and local bodies, and by graduates and teachers, with some nominated by the Governor.

The laws. The **Representation of the People Act, 1950** builds the foundation — allocation of seats, delimitation of constituencies and preparation of electoral rolls — and guarantees every citizen **18+** the right to vote without discrimination. The **RPA, 1951** polices the battle — nomination of candidates, campaigns, voting procedures and post-election disputes — and bans **corrupt practices**: bribery, appeals to vote on religion, caste, race, community or language (communal appeal), and misuse of government personnel (gazetted officers, judges, armed forces, police). A separate Presidential & Vice-Presidential Act (1952) covers those elections. Memory hook: **1950 = rolls, 1951 = conduct and disputes**.

Delimitation. Constituency boundaries are not fixed forever, because populations shift. Without delimitation one MP might represent 5 lakh people and another 25 lakh — defeating **equal representation**. The Constitution's **Article 82** mandates the Delimitation Commission, which fixes the number of seats and the boundaries so the seats-to-population ratio stays nearly equal. It has been set up **four times: 1952, 1963, 1973 and 2002**.

The Election Commission of India (ECI). The Constitution vests in the ECI the **"superintendence, direction and control"** of the entire election process (**Articles 324–329**). Established on **25 January 1950** — now celebrated as **National Voters' Day** — the ECI is an **autonomous, permanent, constitutional body** that conducts elections to Parliament, state legislatures and the offices of President and

Vice-President; at state level it works through the Chief Electoral Officer and district officers. Its four big jobs: (1) **creating and maintaining electoral rolls** — enumerators visit every household, and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) adds new 18-year-olds while removing dead, shifted, duplicate or untraceable entries; (2) **fixing the schedule** — around weather, the agricultural cycle, exams and festivals; (3) **registering political parties and allotting symbols** — it insists on inner-party elections and acts quasi-judicially in symbol disputes; (4) **ensuring free, fair, inclusive elections** — home voting for citizens above **85** and PwDs with **40% benchmark disability** (first nationwide in 2024), Braille EVMs, and digital apps: **Suvidha** (candidate permissions), **Voter Helpline**, **ENCORE** (rolls & forms), **Saksham** (PwD services), **cVIGIL** (report MCC violations), **Sugam** (vehicles) and **ETPBS** (postal ballots for service voters).

Political parties. Voters learn about candidates, policies and vision mainly through parties, which set the election agenda with manifestos and campaigns, organise public opinion and give people real choices. India's **multi-party system** reflects its diversity of languages, cultures, religions and regions. The ECI recognises parties as **national or state parties** by strict criteria — for example, 6% of valid votes in four or more states plus four Lok Sabha seats (or 2% of Lok Sabha seats from at least three states) for a national party; 6% of votes in a state election plus seats for a state party. Parties that don't qualify remain **registered-unrecognised (RUPPs)**.

Defection and coalitions. Defection — an elected member abandoning the party on whose ticket they won (the "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram" syndrome) — destabilised governments, so the **52nd Constitutional Amendment (1985)**, the **Anti-Defection Law**, lets the Speaker or Chairman disqualify a member who voluntarily gives up party membership or votes against the party's **whip**. Coalitions are the other face of a multi-party system: the alliance era began in **1967**; the **Janata Party** formed the first national coalition government in **1977** after the Emergency; since the late 1990s the **NDA** (led by BJP) and **UPA** (led by INC — reconstituted in 2023 as the INDIA alliance) have been the major blocs.

Challenges — and one first vote. With 96.8 crore voters, challenges persist: **misinformation and fake news**, intimidation and money power. The ECI's answers include the RPA, the **Model Code of Conduct (MCC)**, **VVPAT** slips (so voters can verify their vote) and awareness campaigns. The chapter's case study — **Ishani's first vote** — shows inclusion in action: online registration, wheelchair access and volunteers for her disabled brother, home voting for her 89-year-old grandmother, acceptance of documents other than Voter ID, and postal ballots (**ETPBS**) for police and army on duty — though the wall writings and posters near polling day were actually **MCC violations**. No voter is left behind: this is India's **"festival of democracy."**

PART B 10 Must-Know Definitions

TERM	EXAM-READY DEFINITION
Constituency	A **territorial area** whose voters elect **one representative** to the legislature.
Electoral system	The method of **converting votes cast into seats** in the legislature.
First-Past-The-Post (FPTP)	The **plurality system**: the candidate with the most votes wins, even with less than 50% — used for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections.
Majority system	The **two-round system**: a winner needs more than 50% of votes; otherwise the top two candidates compete in a second round.
Proportional Representation (PR)	Seats are allotted to parties **in proportion to the total votes** they receive — used for Rajya Sabha, Presidential and Vice-Presidential elections.
Single Transferable Vote (STV)	A PR method in which voters **mark preferences**; votes of eliminated candidates are **transferred** until enough candidates reach the quota.
Quota	The minimum votes needed to win under STV = **total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled**.
Delimitation	The process of fixing the **number of seats and constituency boundaries** so the seats-to-population ratio stays nearly equal — mandated by **Article 82**.
Defection / Anti-Defection Law	**Defection:** abandoning the party on whose ticket a member was elected. The **52nd Amendment (1985)** disqualifies members who defect or defy the whip; the Speaker/Chairman decides.
VVPAT	**Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail** — a printed slip that lets voters verify that their vote went to the candidate they chose.

PART C 10 MCQs — Test Yourself

1. In the First-Past-The-Post (FPTP) system, the winner is:

(a) the candidate who crosses 50% of the votes
(b) the candidate with the most votes, even if below 50%
(c) the candidate chosen by the ECI
(d) always the ruling party's candidate

2. In the textbook example of Haritbhumi, Party A won 40% of the votes, B 35% and C 25%. Who formed the government?

(a) a B–C coalition
(b) Party A
(c) the top two parties fought a second round
(d) no government could be formed

3. Proportional Representation (through the single transferable vote) is used for elections to the:

(a) Lok Sabha
(b) Vidhan Sabha
(c) Rajya Sabha, President and Vice-President
(d) local bodies

4. In the STV system, the quota — the minimum votes needed to win — equals:

(a) total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled
(b) total votes ÷ candidates
(c) 50% of the total votes
(d) a number fixed by the ECI

5. **Which pair correctly matches the Representation of the People Acts?**

(a) RPA 1950: conduct and disputes; RPA 1951: electoral rolls

(b) RPA 1950: seats, delimitation and electoral rolls; RPA 1951: nomination, campaigns, voting and disputes

(c) both Acts cover exactly the same subjects

(d) RPA 1951: delimitation only

6. **The Delimitation Commission, provided for by _____ of the Constitution, has been set up _____ times so far:**

(a) Article 324; three

(b) Article 82; four — 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002

(c) Article 356; two

(d) Article 368; five

7. **The Election Commission of India was established on 25 January 1950 — a date now celebrated every year as:**

(a) Constitution Day

(b) Democracy Day

(c) National Voters' Day

(d) Republic Day

8. **The Constitution vests the "superintendence, direction and control" of the entire election process in:**

(a) Parliament

(b) the Supreme Court

(c) the Election Commission of India

(d) the President of India

9. **Under the Anti-Defection Law (52nd Amendment, 1985), a member can be disqualified from the House for:**

(a) criticising the government in public

(b) voluntarily giving up party membership or voting against the party's whip

(c) missing Question Hour

(d) joining a parliamentary committee

10. **Which ECI app is correctly matched with its purpose?**

(a) cVIGIL — voters report Model Code of Conduct violations

(b) Saksham — vehicle management

(c) Sugam — services for voters with disabilities

(d) ENCORE — postal ballots for service voters

ANSWER KEY · CIVICS CH 7

1. (b) FPTP = plurality — most votes wins, even below 50%.

2. (b) With the highest share (40%), Party A forms the government under FPTP.

3. (c) PR-STV: Rajya Sabha, President, Vice-President (and Vidhan Parishad).

4. (a) Quota = total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled.

5. (b) 1950 = foundation (rolls, seats, delimitation); 1951 = conduct & disputes.

6. (b) Article 82; four commissions — 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002.

7. (c) ECI established 25 January 1950 → National Voters' Day.

8. (c) Articles 324–329 vest superintendence, direction & control in the ECI.

9. (b) 52nd Amendment (1985): defection or defying the whip → disqualification; Speaker decides.

10. (a) cVIGIL — report MCC violations; flying squads reach the spot within minutes.